A Yep.

Q -- underneath the little coronavirus dots, it says, "Eddie" -- I'm presuming that's Eddie Holmes --

A Yes.

Q -- "has screenshots taken from social media in China about the coronavirus sequence. They suggest the full genome was known by a genomics company in China by 27 December 2019."

A Correct.

Q Were you aware of that?

A Not at the time, no. But, yes -- no. At the time, no, I was not aware of that. But I believe this -- Eddie -- I think Eddie has showed me some of the text messages of whatever he had. So I believe this information to be accurate, but I did not know it at the time.

Q That was going to be my next question. Did Dr. Holmes share any information suggesting this to be true?

A He did, yeah. Not -- I can't remember when he did that. It certainly wasn't in January and February, for example, it was later, especially because there's been so much focus on who released the first genome and all for around that time.

Q Why -- and I'm now asking you to speculate -- but would there be a reason to hold off on the sequence between the 27th of December and January 10th?

Mr. Rowley. By who?

Mr. Benzine. By China.

Dr. Andersen. Yeah. I think -- well, the thing -- again, so this is not specific to China.

Now, I'll say Eddie and I, for example, disagree on this, because I think Eddie

in early January 2020.

And he reaches out to his old colleague and friend Eddie Holmes, who is also a colleague, a friend of myself, asks Eddie about these rumors because Eddie Holmes is one of the most respected scientists, has written books on -- the primary books on viral emergence.

Jeremy asks Eddie: Is there anything to these rumors? Eddie takes a quick look at the data and basically says to Jeremy: No, I don't think so. And then leaves it there.

And I think this appeared, like based on -- I'm, obviously, not privy to those conversations, but this happens on January 27th, according to what Eddie and Jeremy later said.

I get prompted -- I have been looking at just the genome in general but mostly focused on just understanding the virus. I hadn't really consider the origin question yet. I get prompted to do that a little bit more specifically by my chairman on the 30th of January.

I take a quick look at it, and I'm aware of some of the work at the Wuhan Institute of Virology, but I don't really see anything sort of that concerns me. But I decide to take a closer look after being prompted by, again, my chairman at the institution.

I do so and I start seeing things that concerns me, the furin cleavage site, for example, but also just a few things that to me looked unusual at the time.

What's really important to understand here is that I'm an expert on viral evolution and emergence. I study the emergence of viruses. But I'm not a coronaviruses expert. I certainly wasn't at the time. I had not studied coronaviruses previously in any great detail. So there were many things around just the diversity of coronaviruses that was unfamiliar to me at the time.

When I see these things, it's late at night, I think probably on the 31st, so a day

after. Because it's late at night and because I know Eddie is in Australia, he's going to be up, he's awake, and he's a trusted colleague. So I reach out to him and I explain to him in some detail what my very, very early findings were and why I was concerned about it.

And Eddie's expertise and my expertise, while it certainly overlaps a lot, and understanding viral emergence, I have a little bit of a broader background, having done a lot of wet lab work, including manipulating viruses as part of my Ph.D., for example, and understand the wet lab side of things a fair bit better than Eddie does. But then he understands the ecology side better than I do.

And I sort of explained to Eddie that, look, we can't just dismiss this possibility out of hand because of the type of work that was ongoing at the Wuhan Institute of Virology and knew about biosafety levels. And I talked to Eddie here, and he sort of realizes that his early dismissal of this was probably not the correct thing to do.

He does not name -- he doesn't mention Jeremy's name on this initial phone call I have with Eddie. In fact, I think he calls him his handler. And I think this comes from the fact that, again, I think when Jeremy heard these, quote, unquote, rumors, I believe it's the intelligence community in the United Kingdom, he's talked about burner phones in his book. So I believe Jeremy was working at a level in which he didn't want interference, potential interference.

So Eddie contacts Jeremy. Jeremy then contacts me the next day, and that's when I realize it's Jeremy Farrar, because, again, I didn't know that based on the conversation with Eddie. We talk about my concerns and talk about, like, look, we need to get a group together to discuss these concerns that I have, and we need to select people that are unconflicted. So we did.

Ralph Baric, for example, is a name that came up. We all know Ralph. Ralph is a very important coronavirus biologist. But we also knew that Ralph had very close

of -- and I'm paraphrasing him here -- but basically saying that, look, if you think this came from a lab, then you should really consider writing a paper on it so it can be peer reviewed and judged by the community.

And I relayed back to Dr. Fauci that I feel that it's too premature. We need to look at this more closely. We can't just publish a paper just based on no analysis at the time. And, of course, he understands that and looks forward to the conference call in which scientists can get a chance to discuss my findings.

And that's the purpose of the conference call, which, again, is completely organized by Jeremy. Jeremy runs the call. I honestly don't remember Drs. Fauci or Collins even chiming in on the call itself. I'm sure they probably had questions. But this is not their area of expertise and they were just there to hear the scientists discuss what I had brought up. And the discussion is primarily between myself and Andy Rambaut, Eddie Holmes, Christian Drosten, Ron Fouchier, and Marion Koopsman. Those are the main factors I remember here.

At that time, as I had relayed, was that this was not for the purpose of drafting a paper. I think Eddie was probably more focused on a paper already at that stage. I was more like, look, I just want to talk about this, and then I want to do some more analyses, and I want to look into this closer.

I think what -- if I have to -- and, again, I can't because I don't know exactly what Jeremy means, of course. But I actually think he's likely talking about his later efforts to have the WHO look into this because he wanted to -- he thought this was an important question, and he thought it important that it would be something that an international body would take up as a conference and have a group of experts discuss this.

And I know that later on he does put some pressure on the WHO to, in fact, organize this, and I actually think that's what he's referring to in this particular email.

We keep in touch with him as part of our what later becomes the publication, and I will say this sort of like role to like, no, we really should do a publication on this because we have found -- again, first of all, realizing that the very early idea about an engineered virus here just does not make sense based upon the evidence available to us.

But there are more legitimate reasons, for example, to consider a potential cultured virus here. It is I think probably a week after or so is when we get to the stage in which, like, okay, we should actually prepare this for peer review publication, a process mostly driven by Eddie as part of the author group here, but, of course, with all our involvements.

Mr. Pellegrini. Okay. Well, that's helpful. That's helpful context. I appreciate it.

I think what we'll do is continue to look at a few emails on that general topic.

Dr. Andersen. Sure.

Mr. Pellegrini. And so what I'd like to do is introduce what I will label as minority exhibit C.

[Andersen Minority Exhibit C
Was marked for identification.]

BY MR. PELLEGRINI:

Q And so this document, Bates labeled Garry 59, I'll give you a second to glance at it. I'm really only going to focus on the first page of this chain.

Up towards the top of this first page, we have an email from Dr. Holmes, and it looks like he's talking to you, but it's to the whole group. It's yourself and your subsequent co-authors.

A Yep.

Q It says: "Kristian, I think you are right that a careful report is the way to go.

hypotheses, added some evidence to it, added our expertise to saying, like: What do you guys think? You should think of that as a paper, not as a report.

I just think it's a little premature at this stage, which it is. It's 10 days prior to us actually -- almost 10 days prior to us having a draft, a paper that we then submit to Nature for consideration and, in fact, also put online at the time.

Q And so that whole back and forth that you just described is where Dr. Farrar thinks X, you personally think Y.

A Yeah.

Q It does not appear from the email traffic -- I'm curious about your recollection -- that at this point I see nothing in here saying: And Dr. Fauci is pushing us to get another paper out as well, or Dr. Collins. It does not seem that way.

A Again, there is no involvement at any stage of the production of the paper from Drs. Collins or Fauci.

I believe, though, that because Jeremy was trying -- putting some pressure on the WHO to get this conference where this could be considered, I think he might have communicated with Collins on this separately. Because I remember that we talked at the time that Collins was helping Jeremy basically to get a conference set up with the WHO, and probably from that side Jeremy from the U.K. side, maybe Collins from the U.S. side, putting some pressure on the WHO to consider the origin questions in general.

Q But you would not have personal knowledge of --

A I would not have personal knowledge. I did not have any personal communication with Fauci or Collins as part of this other than the email chain that is going on with the participants of the call in which I think Dr. Fauci has a single question, which relates to potential passage in animals, yes.

Q I would like to introduce minority exhibit F.

A He did when I had the first call with him, yes, and he specifically mentioned that if I believed this was a lab leak, I should consider writing a peer-reviewed paper on it.

Q Did you ever feel -- so you've said today and your emails say too that you had some hesitation about publishing proximal origins at least?

A The early versions -- yeah, early versions of it, early drafts of it, yes.

Q Did you ever feel directed by Dr. Farrar to publish?

A No. I think, you know, Eddie Holmes, who is a co-author, definitely put pressure on me in saying, look, Kristian, we really need to, you know, get this into a peer-reviewed paper right now. It was coming from Eddie Holmes, and Eddie was right. It's just -- you know, I think by the time it was published, I still felt it was a little bit too fast, right? Maybe used another week, for example.

But in retrospect, Eddie was absolutely right. It was ready to go. It was ready to -- to be submitted as a peer-reviewed publication at that time.

But, yeah, especially early on in the conversations, the first week of February, for example, there were these talks about a potential pangolin genome which -- a pangolin virus genome, which was reported to basically be almost identical to SARS-CoV-2.

It's like, look, we got to wait for that evidence, but, of course, if that's there, that's really important, right? So we don't want to publish before we have that evidence, so let's just give it a little bit of time, which is what we did. By the time we published, we knew that actually those sequences were -- it was just incorrectly reported.

Q So your hesitation was more that the paper just wasn't ready versus --

A Exactly, right.

Q -- publishing something --

A Oh, not -- not --

Q Your hesitation was more that the paper wasn't ready, not that it wouldn't

stand up to a peer review?

A Absolutely, yeah. I think, you know, my group publishes papers, right, we have a lot of very good papers, and that's our focus on everything we do. So the idea of a peer-reviewed publication, absolutely. It's just, again, I felt, early February, certainly I was, like, look, we know that there's likely more data coming out which is relevant to this question, so let's wait on that, which everybody was agree on -- was in agreement with, right?

But the idea of a peer-reviewed publication is not something I didn't want to do. It's just I thought the state of the drafts of what eventually will become proximal were not ready at the time.

Q I'm going to introduce majority exhibit 15.

[Andersen Majority Exhibit No. 15
Was marked for identification.]

BY MR. BENZINE:

Q It's the final version of the proximal origin paper, which has been previously introduced?

A Yep.

Q Not that you need to read it again, but --

A Sure.

Q -- I want to go through briefly, because we've spent some time on it --

A Yeah.

Q -- some of the ideas in here and first start again to get a little bit more clarity on the final sentence in the "To the Editor" block, that, Our analyses clearly show that SARS-CoV-2 is not a laboratory construct or a purposefully manipulated virus.

A Right.